

Design System: Postly

Step A: Choose your styling approach

- **Approach:** Tailwind CSS (using theme configuration or CSS variables for custom design tokens).

Step B: Colour Tokens ("Demure & Dreamy" Palette)

A soft, muted, and ethereal color scheme designed to feel calm, nostalgic, and gentle on the eyes (all background-to-text pairs exceed 4.5:1 contrast).

Token	Role	Colour & Hex	Visual Swatch
--color-primary	links, buttons, active states	#7C8B99	 Muted Slate-Rose (#7C8B99)
--color-accent	one call-to-action, highlights	#D4A373	 Antique Gold (#D4A373)
--color-bg	page background	#FDFBF7	 Heirloom Cream (#FDFBF7)
--color-surface	cards, panels	#F5F2EB	 Linen White (#F5F2EB)
--color-text	body text	#3C403D	 Charcoal Slate (#3C403D)

Step C: Type Scale

A clean, airy, typewriter-inspired or humanist font scale for a nostalgic aesthetic.

Style	Size	Weight	Used for
Heading	24px / 1.5rem	Bold (600)	Screen and section titles
Body	16px / 1rem	Regular (400)	Paragraphs, lists, postcard captions
Small	13px / 0.8125rem	Regular (400)	Captions, timestamps, form labels, footer

Step D: Spacing Rule

- **Base Unit:** 8px grid system.
 - **Tight spacing (--space-1):** 8px (between related form fields, tags, and icons).
 - **Standard spacing (--space-4):** 32px (between major layout sections and cards).
 - **Screen edge padding:** 24px (ensuring a comfortable, breathing border on all viewports).
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Step E: Reusable Components

Component	Level	Appears on	Props it takes
Button	atom	Everywhere	variant, onClick, children, disabled
Input / CaptionField	molecule	Capture, Settings	value, onChange, placeholder, label
PostcardCard	molecule	Gallery, Home	postcard (imageUrl, caption, createdAt, templateId)
HeaderNav	organism	All screens	activeRoute

Component	Level	Appears on	Props it takes
<code>PostcardPreview</code>	organism	Capture	<code>imageUrl</code> , <code>caption</code> , <code>selectedTemplate</code>

Step F: Responsive Plan

- **Below 768px (Phone):** Cards collapse to a single vertical column, navigation collapses into a mobile-friendly menu bar, and the capture form stacks cleanly above the live preview.
 - **Above 768px (Desktop):** Expands to multi-column CSS grids (e.g., 3-column gallery, 2-column capture layout with side-by-side preview). Strict prevention of horizontal scrolling (`max-width: 100vw`).
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Accessibility Check

- ☒ Every text-on-background pair passes 4.5:1 contrast (verified for charcoal text on cream/linen backgrounds).
- ☒ Real semantic elements (`<header>`, `<nav>`, `<main>`, `<button>`) utilized throughout.
- ☒ Every meaningful image has `alt` text (decorative stamps/backgrounds use `alt=""`).
- ☒ Every form input has a matching `<label>` (`htmlFor + id`).
- ☒ Focus states are visible and keyboard navigable via standard Tab interactions.